BIOLOGY COLLOQUIUM SERIES | FALL 2026



Developing novel methods in support of Forensic DNA typing: Direct PCR, epigenetics, and microbial transfer

Mon, October 12th
12:00 – 1:30 PM
RB 130

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Over the past 30 years, Forensic DNA typing has become the gold standard for detecting and prosecuting criminal activity. However, work in our research group continues with a goal to improve outcomes and specificity. We focus on the development of advanced methods in molecular genetics to enhance DNA analysis. This includes utilizing ultra high speed and microfluidic methods for genotyping, investigating epigenetic markers for determining age and phenotype of unknown suspects, and utilizing microbial methods with digital PCR and deep sequencing to detect sexual assault and food poisoning. This presentation will begin with a brief overview of the author's nearly 30 years work in developing modern DNA methods, discus present research efforts and conclude with thoughts on future developments in the field.